

1776 - 2026 • AMERICA'S 250TH ANNIVERSARY • SEMIQUINCENTENNIAL EDITION

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

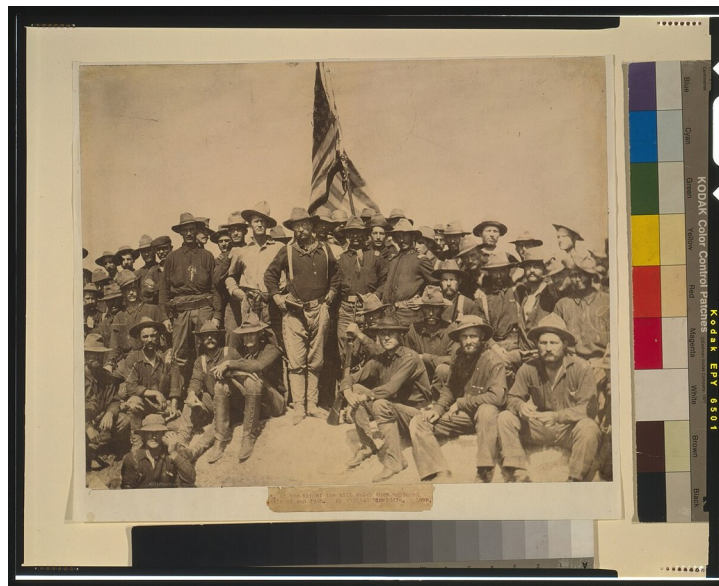
TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES

UNIT 3

Imperialism and World War I, 1890–1920

COURSE STANDARD EDITION

US.19 – US.27 • 9 Tennessee U.S. History Standards • Grades 9–12



Colonel Theodore Roosevelt and the Rough Riders atop San Juan Heights, Cuba, 1898.
Source: William Dinwiddie / Library of Congress. Public domain.

TENNESSEE CONNECTION • SERGEANT ALVIN C. YORK

Over 90,000 Tennesseans served in World War I. Alvin C. York of Pall Mall, Fentress County, became one of the most decorated American soldiers of the war — on October 8, 1918 he helped capture 132 German soldiers and earned the Medal of Honor (US.24–US.25).

One common workbook designed for learner variability. Every student works toward the same Tennessee standards; supports vary the means, not the goal or the ceiling.

Release-Ready • Pilot Edition

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U.S. History Hack™ — Unit 3: Imperialism and World War I (1890–1920), Course Standard Edition.

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Source integrity. Every primary source in this unit is public-domain and cited to its holding repository (National Archives, Library of Congress, HathiTrust). See the Source Library.

Reading provenance (district-clear). Close-Read passages are labeled “History Hack-authored instructional synthesis” — they build on the standard record and are not presented as primary sources.

Framework stack. This workbook anchors to Tennessee U.S. History standards US.19–US.27 and the Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–SSP.06), and is designed on CAST UDL 3.0 and an MTSS support model.

Pacing. Each standard is built for **one 45-minute class period**. Each activity shows a 🕒 ~ **minutes** estimate at its heading. There is more here than one period holds — your teacher chooses which activities you do in class; the rest may become warm-ups, stations, or homework.

Table of Contents

Tennessee Standards & SSP Crosswalk

Each standard below is taught to the full Course Standard expectation; the Social Studies Practices are embedded in every activity cycle.

Standard	Focus	Lenses
US.19	Causes of American Imperialism	History • Geography • Economics
US.20	Interventionists vs Non-Interventionists	Politics/Government • Culture • History
US.21	Spanish-American War & Imperialism Outcomes	History • Geography
US.22	Diplomatic Policies: Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral Diplomacy	Politics/Government • History • Geography
US.23	Causes of World War I & U.S. Neutrality	History • Politics/Government
US.24	Reasons for American Entry into World War I	History • Politics/Government
US.25	Key Figures and Developments in World War I	History • Geography • Tennessee Connection
US.26	World War I Home Front	History • Economics • Culture
US.27	Wilson's Fourteen Points and League of Nations	Politics/Government • History • Culture

Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–SSP.06)

SSP.01 Gather/evaluate sources • SSP.02 Critically examine a primary source • SSP.03 Synthesize evidence • SSP.04 Construct/communicate argument • SSP.05 Develop historical awareness • SSP.06 Chronological/spatial reasoning. Each Close Read, Primary Source/Data, and CER activity names the practices it builds.

Accessibility, UDL & Accommodations Matrix

One firm learning goal per standard; flexible, universal means. Supports are available by design and never lower the goal. They work alongside — never in place of — required IEP or 504 accommodations.

Universal support	What it is	Where it appears
CORE PATH	Essential instruction every student completes	Every activity
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, Spanish cognates	Word Bank, Guided/Light Backs
RESPONSE CHOICE	Write, say/record, or diagram	Every activity
SUPPORT OPTION	Optional scaffold that keeps the goal	Guided Support Back, Primary Source
PROGRESS CHECK	Quick DOK-2/3 check to guide reteach/extend	Cornell Notes, Practice Quiz
EXTENSION	Deeper challenge once the goal is met	Extension Bank, CER

How CAST UDL 3.0 is visible in this workbook

Multiple means of Engagement (response choice, relevance via Tennessee Connection), Representation (Word Bank, pronunciation, Spanish, Close-Read supports), and Action & Expression (write/say/diagram, Frayer, CER). No fixed-track labels appear.

My Support Plan (optional — you choose)

Supports are available by design. Check the ones you might try; you can change your mind any time.

Support I might use	When it would help me
Word Bank + Spanish column	
Guided or Light Support Back	
Response choice (say/record or diagram)	
Sentence frames / Rehearsal Lab	

How to Use This Workbook

Each standard runs the same seven-activity cycle: (1) Vocabulary Word Bank, (2) Vocabulary Studio, (3) Direct-Teaching Cornell Notes with optional Guided and Light Support Backs, (4) Close Read, (5) Primary Source / Data Analysis, (6) Core Application Practice Quiz, (7) Constructed Response (CER). Work the CORE PATH; reach for SUPPORT OPTIONS as needed.

Label legend — these appear throughout every standard cycle

Label	Meaning
CORE PATH	The essential instruction every student completes.
SUPPORT OPTION	An optional scaffold that keeps the goal, not lowers it.
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, and Spanish cognates for access.
RESPONSE CHOICE	Show learning by writing, saying/recording, or diagramming.
PROGRESS CHECK	A quick DOK-2/3 check that guides reteach or extend.
EXTENSION	A deeper challenge once the goal is met.

Before You Begin — Set Your Goal

This unit asks one big question: as the United States industrialized, who benefited and who bore the costs? Set a goal, then note what you already know.

Prompt	Your response
My goal for this unit is...	
One thing I already know about this era...	
One question I want answered...	

Standard US.19 — Causes of American Imperialism

TN Academic Standard US.19: Assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including: the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism.

Lenses for this standard: History • Geography • Economics

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Causes of American Imperialism: Assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including: the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.19 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Imperialism	A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.	Imperialismo
Yellow Journalism	Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.	Periodismo Amarillo
Alfred Thayer Mahan	U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.	Alfred Thayer Mahan
Spanish-American War	A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.	Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense
Roosevelt Corollary	Theodore Roosevelt's 1904 addition to the Monroe Doctrine, asserting the U.S. right to intervene in Latin American countries to maintain stability and prevent European intervention.	Corolario Roosevelt
Theodore Roosevelt	The 26th U.S. President (1901-1909) known for progressive reforms, trust-busting, conservation, and aggressive foreign policy including building the Panama Canal and expanding American influence.	Theodore Roosevelt

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Imperialism (im-PEER-ee-uh-liz-um); Alfred Thayer Mahan (AL-fred THAY-er muh-HAN); Roosevelt Corollary (ROH-zuh-velt KOR-uh-lair-ee).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Imperialism	_____	_____	_____	_____
Yellow Journalism	_____	_____	_____	_____
Alfred Thayer Mahan	_____	_____	_____	_____
Spanish-American War	_____	_____	_____	_____
Roosevelt Corollary	_____	_____	_____	_____
Theodore Roosevelt	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.19 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Imperialism** • ES: Imperialismo

Word-bank meaning to build on: A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Imperialism” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Yellow Journalism** • ES: Periodismo Amarillo

Word-bank meaning to build on: Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Yellow Journalism” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.19 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.19 — Causes of American Imperialism • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Economic Motivations for Expansion	
Spreading Democratic & Moral Ideals	
Yellow Journalism & Public Opinion	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.19

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Imperialism • Yellow Journalism • Alfred Thayer Mahan • Spanish-American War • Roosevelt Corollary • Theodore Roosevelt

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Analyze how economic, moral, and media factors combined to create support for American expansion overseas.

- A. Economic interests created motivation, moral justifications provided legitimacy, and yellow journalism built popular support—together creating an irresistible push for imperialism
- B. Only one factor mattered; the others were irrelevant, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C. These factors worked against each other, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D. Public opinion was never important for imperial policy, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.19 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Economic Motivations for Expansion

American imperialism was driven significantly by economic factors. The growing industrial economy needed raw materials like sugar from Hawaii, rubber, oil, and minerals to fuel production. Expanding American manufacturing required overseas consumers for surplus goods, and capitalists sought profitable investment opportunities in underdeveloped regions. Strategic naval bases and coaling stations were needed for global commerce and military presence, and fear that European powers would monopolize global markets created urgency for American expansion.

Spreading American Democratic and Moral Ideals

Many Americans believed they had a duty to "civilize" and Christianize peoples they considered "backward"—a concept captured in Rudyard Kipling's poem "White Man's Burden." Social Darwinism applied evolutionary theory to justify American superiority and expansion. The ideology of Manifest Destiny, which had driven continental expansion, was extended to overseas territories. Missionary activity provided religious motivation, while belief in American exceptionalism held that U.S. political and social institutions were superior and should be exported worldwide.

Yellow Journalism and Public Opinion

Yellow journalism—sensationalized newspaper reporting that exaggerated stories to sell papers—played a crucial role in building public support for imperialism. Key figures William Randolph Hearst (New York Journal) and Joseph Pulitzer (New York World) used dramatic headlines, emotional appeals, and fabricated or exaggerated stories. Coverage of alleged Spanish atrocities in Cuba particularly inflamed public opinion, forcing politicians to adopt more aggressive foreign policies. This represented the first major example of mass media shaping American foreign policy.

Key terms first: Imperialism, Yellow Journalism. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "Economic Motivations for Expansion" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Spreading American Democratic and Moral Ideals" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Yellow Journalism and Public Opinion" section, and what evidence supports it?		

Geographer's Lens — US.19 ~12 min

Geographers don't just find places — they explain how WHERE shapes WHAT happens. Work these like a geographer. Built on the Five Themes of Geography • C3 Dimension 2 • SSP.06 (spatial reasoning).

MOVEMENT & REGION — what's the spatial pattern?

In 1–2 sentences: is this a movement, a cluster, or a whole region? Name the direction or shape it takes on a map.

GEOGRAPHY AS A FORCE — how did location shape the outcome?

How did geography change WHAT happened — who was affected, how far or fast it spread, or who was left out? Use one place above as your evidence.

READ IT LIKE A SOURCE — RESPONSE CHOICE

A map is a source with a point of view. Show your thinking your way — write it, OR sketch a quick arrows-and-labels diagram: what would a map of this make CLEAR, and what would it HIDE or leave out?

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.19 ~15 min

Primary source (political cartoon) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



The infant Hercules and the Standard Oil serpents / Frank A. Nankivell 1906. • Nankivell, Frank A. (Frank Arthur), 1869-1959, artist • 1906

Source: Nankivell, Frank A. \"The infant Hercules and the Standard Oil serpents.\" Political cartoon. New York: J. Ottmann Lith. Co., 1906. Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, Illus. in AP101.P7 1906 (Case X) [P&P], <https://www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2011645893/>. Public Domain — No Known Restrictions on Publication <https://www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2011645893/>

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	
SUPPORT OPTION	
Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.	
CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN	
Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____	

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.19 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us19-q2 • pre-field-test]

How did the belief in spreading American democratic and moral ideals justify imperial expansion?

- A. Concepts like "White Man's Burden," Social Darwinism, and extended Manifest Destiny held that Americans had a duty to spread civilization and Christianity
- B. Americans rejected any moral justification for expansion, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C. Americans believed other nations were already democratic, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- D. Moral ideals played no role in imperial arguments, which does not align with the documented historical record and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic

[DOK 2 • item us19-q3 • pre-field-test]

What role did yellow journalism play in building public support for American imperialism?

- A. It had no influence on public opinion, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation
- B. Sensationalized reporting by Hearst and Pulitzer inflamed public opinion against Spain and created pressure for military intervention
- C. It only covered domestic news stories, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- D. It encouraged isolationism and non-intervention, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

[DOK 3 • item u1-us19-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Analyze how economic, moral, and media factors combined to create support for American expansion overseas.

- A. Economic interests created motivation, moral justifications provided legitimacy, and yellow journalism built popular support—together creating an irresistible push for imperialism
- B. Only one factor mattered; the others were irrelevant, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C. These factors worked against each other, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D. Public opinion was never important for imperial policy, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.19 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us19-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

What economic factors drove American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries?

- A. Desire to reduce American manufacturing output, but the historical record tells a more complex story
- B. Fear of domestic economic growth, which represents a common misconception about the period
- C. Need for raw materials, new markets for surplus goods, and investment opportunities abroad
- D. Wish to import European political systems, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐

Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.20 — Interventionists vs Non-Interventionists

TN Academic Standard US.20: Compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period.

Lenses for this standard: Politics/Government • Culture • History

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Interventionists vs Non-Interventionists: Compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.20 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Imperialism	A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.	Imperialismo
Yellow Journalism	Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.	Periodismo Amarillo
Alfred Thayer Mahan	U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.	Alfred Thayer Mahan
Spanish-American War	A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.	Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense
Roosevelt Corollary	Theodore Roosevelt's 1904 addition to the Monroe Doctrine, asserting the U.S. right to intervene in Latin American countries to maintain stability and prevent European intervention.	Corolario Roosevelt
Emilio Aguinaldo	Filipino independence leader who initially fought alongside Americans against Spain, then led the Philippine resistance against U.S. occupation (1899-1901).	Emilio Aguinaldo

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Imperialism (im-PEER-ee-uh-liz-um); Alfred Thayer Mahan (AL-fred THAY-er muh-HAN); Roosevelt Corollary (ROH-zuh-velt KOR-uh-lair-ee); Emilio Aguinaldo (eh-MEE-lee-oh ah-gee-NAHL-doh).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Imperialism	_____	_____	_____	_____
Yellow Journalism	_____	_____	_____	_____
Alfred Thayer Mahan	_____	_____	_____	_____
Spanish-American War	_____	_____	_____	_____
Roosevelt Corollary	_____	_____	_____	_____
Emilio Aguinaldo	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.20 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Imperialism** • ES: Imperialismo

Word-bank meaning to build on: A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Imperialism” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Yellow Journalism** • ES: Periodismo Amarillo

Word-bank meaning to build on: Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Yellow Journalism” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.20 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.20 — Interventionists vs Non-Interventionists • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Interventionist Arguments	
Non-Interventionist Arguments	
Political, Economic & Moral Factors	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.20

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Imperialism • Yellow Journalism • Alfred Thayer Mahan • Spanish-American War • Roosevelt Corollary • Emilio Aguinaldo

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Compare the political, economic, and moral factors that divided interventionists and non-interventionists.

- A. Both sides agreed on all major points, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- B. Interventionists emphasized global power projection, economic opportunity, and civilizing mission while non-interventionists stressed limited government, costs, and self-determination
- C. Only economic factors created disagreement, but this fails to account for the broader historical context despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- D. Moral arguments were identical on both sides, although historical sources do not support this conclusion when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.20 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Interventionist Arguments

Interventionists argued that overseas markets were essential for American prosperity and preventing economic depression. They believed America needed naval bases and strategic positions to protect its interests, and had a moral duty to spread democracy, Christianity, and civilization. Key figures like Theodore Roosevelt, Henry Cabot Lodge, and Alfred Thayer Mahan argued that the U.S. must compete with European powers for global influence or be left behind. They also pointed to humanitarian reasons to help oppressed peoples gain freedom from tyrannical rulers.

Non-Interventionist Arguments

Non-interventionists, including William Jennings Bryan, Andrew Carnegie, and Mark Twain, raised constitutional concerns that imperialism violated American principles of self-government and consent of the governed. They worried about the economic costs of military adventures and argued it was morally wrong to impose American rule on unwilling peoples. Some had racial concerns about incorporating non-white populations, while others emphasized the anti-militarism tradition and Washington's warning against foreign entanglements. The American Anti-Imperialist League organized formal opposition.

Comparing Political, Economic, and Moral Factors

Politically, interventionists believed American power should be projected globally with strong executive authority, while non-interventionists favored limited government and congressional control. Economically, interventionists emphasized overseas markets and resources, while opponents worried about the costs of military commitments. Morally, interventionists stressed the civilizing mission and humanitarian intervention, while non-interventionists emphasized self-determination and constitutional principles. Regional differences also emerged, with the Northeast and West more interventionist, the South and Midwest more isolationist.

Key terms first: Imperialism, Yellow Journalism. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the “Interventionist Arguments” section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the “Non-Interventionist Arguments” section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the “Comparing Political, Economic, and Moral Factors” section, and what evidence supports it?		

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.20 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

TRUE VERSION OF THE PHILIPPINE REVOLUTION

"I have tried to avoid, as far as possible, parsing judgment on the conduct of the Americans... But the very same Americans who in Paris have concluded negotiations... have treated us, Filipinos, as a people who had contributed nothing to th"

Source: Emilio Aguinaldo, 1899. Aguinaldo, Emilio. "True Version of the Philippine Revolution." 1899. Library of Congress, www.loc.gov/item/08029953/. Public domain. <https://www.loc.gov/item/08029953/>

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

SUPPORT OPTION

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

EXTEND & RE-ENGAGE (open to all)

Push past the document — corroborate, contextualize, and judge its meaning.

Historian move	Your response
Corroborate — what other source would confirm or complicate this one?	
Contextualize — what was happening at the time that explains it?	
So what? — why does this source still matter?	

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.20 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us20-q2 • pre-field-test]

How did non-interventionists challenge the case for American imperialism?

- A. They argued imperialism violated constitutional principles, was costly, contradicted democratic ideals, and went against Washington's warning about foreign entanglements
- B. They supported all forms of expansion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C. They had no organized opposition, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D. They only opposed economic expansion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

[DOK 2 • item q-us20-dok3-107 • pre-field-test]

Compare the political arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists regarding imperialism:

- A. It reflected a conflict between international cooperation and preserving U.S. foreign-policy autonomy
- B. Interventionists saw expansion as destiny while non-interventionists feared constitutional violations
- C. The Platt Amendment gave the U.S. significant control over Cuban affairs despite formal independence
- D. The Court began upholding New Deal legislation, a shift called "the switch in time that saved nine"

[DOK 3 • item u1-us20-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Compare the political, economic, and moral factors that divided interventionists and non-interventionists.

- A. Both sides agreed on all major points, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- B. Interventionists emphasized global power projection, economic opportunity, and civilizing mission while non-interventionists stressed limited government, costs, and self-determination
- C. Only economic factors created disagreement, but this fails to account for the broader historical context despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- D. Moral arguments were identical on both sides, although historical sources do not support this conclusion when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.20 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us20-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

What arguments did interventionists make for American overseas expansion and involvement?

- A. America should withdraw from all international affairs, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation
- B. The Constitution prohibited any foreign involvement, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work
- C. America lacked the military capability for expansion, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors
- D. Economic benefits from overseas markets, strategic naval positions, moral duty to spread democracy, and competition with European powers

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐

Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.21 — Spanish-American War & Imperialism Outcomes

TN Academic Standard US.21: Describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including: Annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, Access to Cuba.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including the annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, and access to Cuba.

Lenses for this standard: History • Geography

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

★ Tennessee Connection

Tennessee sent thousands of volunteers to the Spanish-American War of 1898, continuing the state's tradition as the 'Volunteer State' — a nickname earned during the Mexican-American War. Tennessee regiments served in Cuba and the Philippines.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Spanish-American War & Imperialism Outcomes: Describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including: Annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, Access to Cuba. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.21 ⌚ ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Spanish-American War	A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.	Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense
Philippine Insurrection	A guerrilla war (1899-1902) fought by Filipino independence fighters against U.S. forces after the Spanish-American War, when Filipinos realized America intended to rule rather than liberate them.	Insurrección Filipina
Panama Canal	A man-made waterway connecting the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, built by the United States (1904-1914) after supporting Panama's independence from Colombia.	Canal de Panamá
Roosevelt Corollary	Theodore Roosevelt's 1904 addition to the Monroe Doctrine, asserting the U.S. right to intervene in Latin American countries to maintain stability and prevent European intervention.	Corolario Roosevelt
Theodore Roosevelt	The 26th U.S. President (1901-1909) known for progressive reforms, trust-busting, conservation, and aggressive foreign policy including building the Panama Canal and expanding American influence.	Theodore Roosevelt
Emilio Aguinaldo	Filipino independence leader who initially fought alongside Americans against Spain, then led the Philippine resistance against U.S. occupation (1899-1901).	Emilio Aguinaldo

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Philippine Insurrection (FILL-uh-peen in-suh-REK-shun); Roosevelt Corollary (ROH-zuh-velt KOR-uh-lair-ee); Emilio Aguinaldo (eh-MEE-lee-oh ah-gee-NAHL-doh).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Spanish-American War	_____	_____	_____	_____
Philippine Insurrection	_____	_____	_____	_____
Panama Canal	_____	_____	_____	_____
Roosevelt Corollary	_____	_____	_____	_____
Theodore Roosevelt	_____	_____	_____	_____
Emilio Aguinaldo	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.21 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Spanish-American War** • ES: Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense

Word-bank meaning to build on: A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Spanish-American War” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Philippine Insurrection** • ES: Insurrección Filipina

Word-bank meaning to build on: A guerrilla war (1899-1902) fought by Filipino independence fighters against U.S. forces after the Spanish-American War, when Filipinos realized America intended to rule rather than liberate them.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Philippine Insurrection” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.21 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.21 — Spanish-American War & Imperialism Outcomes • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Causes of the Spanish-American War	
Territorial Outcomes of Imperialism	
Cuba & the Roosevelt Corollary	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.21

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Spanish-American War • Philippine Insurrection • Panama Canal • Roosevelt Corollary • Theodore Roosevelt • Emilio Aguinaldo

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Analyze whether the benefits of American imperialism outweighed the costs and controversies it created.

- A. Benefits clearly outweighed all costs, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B. There were no benefits to American imperialism, but this fails to account for the broader historical context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C. America gained strategic bases, markets, and global influence, but faced costly conflicts like the Philippine Insurrection, contradicted democratic ideals, and created lasting resentment—a complex legacy with both gains and significant moral and practical costs
- D. Imperialism had no lasting consequences, which does not align with the documented historical record, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.21 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Causes of the Spanish-American War

The Cuban rebellion against Spanish rule (1895) created a humanitarian crisis and threatened American sugar investments. The USS Maine explosion in Havana Harbor (February 15, 1898) killed 266 Americans, with yellow journalism blaming Spain despite unclear evidence. The de Lôme Letter, in which the Spanish ambassador insulted President McKinley, further inflamed opinion. Reports of Spanish atrocities in Cuban concentration camps combined with "Remember the Maine!" headlines to push America toward war.

Territorial Outcomes of American Imperialism

Hawaii was annexed in 1898 after American sugar planters had dominated its economy and overthrown Queen Liliuokalani (1893), providing Pearl Harbor as a strategic naval base. The Treaty of Paris gave the U.S. Puerto Rico, Guam, and the Philippines. The Philippine Insurrection (1899-1902) followed when Filipinos under Emilio Aguinaldo fought for independence they expected after Spain's defeat, resulting in 200,000+ Filipino deaths before American victory. The Panama Canal (1904-1914) was secured after the U.S. supported Panamanian independence from Colombia.

Cuba and the Roosevelt Corollary

The Teller Amendment had promised Cuban independence, but the Platt Amendment (1901) restricted Cuban sovereignty and allowed U.S. intervention, establishing Guantanamo Bay as a permanent naval base. American companies came to control Cuban sugar. The Roosevelt Corollary (1904) extended the Monroe Doctrine, declaring the U.S. would act as "international police power" to prevent European intervention in Latin America. This was used to justify interventions in the Dominican Republic, Nicaragua, and Haiti, establishing American hegemony in the Western Hemisphere.

Key terms first: Spanish-American War, Philippine Insurrection. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "Causes of the Spanish-American War" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Territorial Outcomes of American Imperialism" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Cuba and the Roosevelt Corollary" section, and what evidence supports it?		

Geographer's Lens — US.21 ~12 min

Geographers don't just find places — they explain how *WHERE* shapes *WHAT* happens. Work these like a geographer. Built on the Five Themes of Geography • C3 Dimension 2 • SSP.06 (spatial reasoning).

THE PLACES — then explain why geography put them there

Map the territories the United States gained or controlled after the Spanish-American War (1898). The places and where they are are listed below — you do NOT have to know them from memory.

Place	Where	What happened (given)	Why HERE? (your analysis)
Cuba	Caribbean	U.S. protectorate after 1898 (Platt Amendment)	_____
Puerto Rico	Caribbean	became a U.S. territory	_____
Philippines	Pacific / SE Asia	annexed by the U.S. after the war	_____
Guam	Pacific	ceded by Spain to the U.S.	_____
Hawaii	Pacific	annexed by the U.S. in 1898	_____

MOVEMENT & REGION — what's the spatial pattern?

In 1–2 sentences: is this a movement, a cluster, or a whole region? Name the direction or shape it takes on a map.

GEOGRAPHY AS A FORCE — how did location shape the outcome?

How did geography change *WHAT* happened — who was affected, how far or fast it spread, or who was left out? Use one place above as your evidence.

READ IT LIKE A SOURCE — RESPONSE CHOICE

A map is a source with a point of view. Show your thinking your way — write it, OR sketch a quick arrows-and-labels diagram: what would a map of this make CLEAR, and what would it HIDE or leave out?

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.21 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

LETTER TO HENRY CABOT LODGE

"It has been a splendid little war; begun with the highest motives, carried on with magnificent intelligence and spirit, favored by that fortune which loves the brave. It is not often that a nation has the chance to win such triumphs in war,"

Source: Theodore Roosevelt, July 1898. Roosevelt, Theodore. "Letter to Henry Cabot Lodge." July 1898. Library of Congress, www.loc.gov/collections/theodore-roosevelt-papers/. Public domain. <https://www.loc.gov/collections/theodore-roosevelt-papers/>

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

SUPPORT OPTION

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

EXTEND & RE-ENGAGE (open to all)

Push past the document — corroborate, contextualize, and judge its meaning.

Historian move	Your response
Corroborate — what other source would confirm or complicate this one?	
Contextualize — what was happening at the time that explains it?	
So what? — why does this source still matter?	

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.21 ⌚ ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us21-q2 • pre-field-test]

How did American victories result in territorial acquisitions like Hawaii, the Philippines, and influence over Cuba?

- A. Hawaii was annexed for its strategic Pearl Harbor base, the Treaty of Paris transferred Philippines, Puerto Rico, and Guam, and the Platt Amendment gave the U.S. control over Cuban affairs
- B. America gained no new territories, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C. Spain voluntarily gave all territories to America, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- D. Only Cuba became American territory, which does not align with the documented historical record, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise

[DOK 2 • item us21-q3 • pre-field-test]

What challenges did the United States face in governing new territories, particularly during the Philippine Insurrection?

- A. There were no challenges to American rule, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B. Filipinos expected independence and fought a guerrilla war against American occupation, resulting in over 200,000 deaths before the U.S. established control
- C. The Philippines welcomed American rule immediately, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- D. Only economic problems affected the territories, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

[DOK 3 • item u1-us21-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Analyze whether the benefits of American imperialism outweighed the costs and controversies it created.

- A. Benefits clearly outweighed all costs, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B. There were no benefits to American imperialism, but this fails to account for the broader historical context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C. America gained strategic bases, markets, and global influence, but faced costly conflicts like the Philippine Insurrection, contradicted democratic ideals, and created lasting resentment—a complex legacy with both gains and significant moral and practical costs
- D. Imperialism had no lasting consequences, which does not align with the documented historical record, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.21 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including the annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, and access to Cuba? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us21-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

What specific events and factors led to the outbreak of the Spanish-American War in 1898?

- A. The Cuban rebellion, USS Maine explosion, de Lôme Letter, yellow journalism coverage, and humanitarian concerns combined to push America toward war
- B. Only the sinking of the Maine caused the war, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C. Spain declared war on the United States first, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D. Economic factors played no role in the conflict, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐

Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.22 — Diplomatic Policies: Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral Diplomacy

TN Academic Standard US.22: Compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Woodrow Wilson's Moral Diplomacy.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Wilson's Moral Diplomacy.

Lenses for this standard: Politics/Government • History • Geography

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

★ Tennessee Connection

Cordell Hull of Pickett County, Tennessee, served in Congress during the era of competing diplomatic philosophies. Hull favored international trade agreements over military intervention — a position that would later define his tenure as the longest-serving Secretary of State and earn him the Nobel Peace Prize.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Diplomatic Policies: Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral Diplomacy: Compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Woodrow Wilson's Moral Diplomacy. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.22 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Big Stick Diplomacy	Theodore Roosevelt's foreign policy approach summarized as "speak softly and carry a big stick," combining negotiation with the implicit threat of military force.	Diplomacia del Gran Garrote
Dollar Diplomacy	President William Howard Taft's foreign policy emphasizing American business investment and loans to extend influence abroad, especially in Latin America and East Asia.	Diplomacia del Dólar
Moral Diplomacy	Woodrow Wilson's foreign policy rejecting imperialism and emphasizing support for democratic governments and self-determination, though often inconsistently applied.	Diplomacia Moral
Theodore Roosevelt	The 26th U.S. President (1901-1909) known for progressive reforms, trust-busting, conservation, and aggressive foreign policy including building the Panama Canal and expanding American influence.	Theodore Roosevelt
William Howard Taft	The 27th U.S. President (1909-1913) who promoted Dollar Diplomacy, using American economic power to extend influence in Latin America and Asia.	William Howard Taft
Woodrow Wilson	The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.	Woodrow Wilson

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Use the Spanish column in the Word Bank above to access these terms — cognates and translations support understanding, not translation of assessment.

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Big Stick Diplomacy	_____	_____	_____	_____
Dollar Diplomacy	_____	_____	_____	_____
Moral Diplomacy	_____	_____	_____	_____
Theodore Roosevelt	_____	_____	_____	_____
William Howard Taft	_____	_____	_____	_____
Woodrow Wilson	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.22 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Big Stick Diplomacy** • ES: Diplomacia del Gran Garrote

Word-bank meaning to build on: Theodore Roosevelt's foreign policy approach summarized as "speak softly and carry a big stick," combining negotiation with the implicit threat of military force.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses "Big Stick Diplomacy" to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Dollar Diplomacy** • ES: Diplomacia del Dólar

Word-bank meaning to build on: President William Howard Taft's foreign policy emphasizing American business investment and loans to extend influence abroad, especially in Latin America and East Asia.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses "Dollar Diplomacy" to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.22 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.22 — Diplomatic Policies: Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral Diplomacy • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Big Stick Diplomacy	
Dollar Diplomacy	
Moral Diplomacy	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.22

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Big Stick Diplomacy • Dollar Diplomacy • Moral Diplomacy • Theodore Roosevelt • William Howard Taft • Woodrow Wilson

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Evaluate the effectiveness of these three diplomatic approaches in advancing American interests.

- A. All three approaches were equally effective, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B. None of the approaches achieved any goals, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- C. Only economic approaches were effective, which does not align with the documented historical record and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- D. Big Stick Diplomacy achieved clear results through credible force, Dollar Diplomacy struggled without military backup, and Moral Diplomacy inspired but sometimes proved unrealistic—each revealed different tools of statecraft with varying effectiveness

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.22 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick Diplomacy (1901-1909)

"Speak softly and carry a big stick" meant using diplomacy backed by military force. Roosevelt believed America should be respected and feared as a world power. Key strategies included building a powerful navy, using threat of force to achieve objectives, and acting as mediator when it served American interests. Applications included the Great White Fleet naval demonstration (1907-1909), mediating the Russo-Japanese War (winning Roosevelt the Nobel Peace Prize), the Roosevelt Corollary, and supporting Panamanian independence to secure canal rights.

William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy (1909-1913)

Taft believed economic influence was more effective and less costly than military force. His strategy encouraged American investment in foreign countries, used financial leverage to influence governments, and sought to replace European influence with American economic control. Applications included attempting to secure American participation in Chinese railway development and encouraging American banks to refinance foreign debts in Latin America. Results were mixed—Dollar Diplomacy often required military intervention anyway and was less successful than Roosevelt's approach.

Woodrow Wilson's Moral Diplomacy (1913-1921)

Wilson believed foreign policy should reflect American moral values and democratic ideals. His philosophy was to support only legitimate, democratic governments, oppose tyranny, and use moral persuasion rather than force when possible. Applications included refusing to recognize Mexico's Huerta government, entering World War I to "make the world safe for democracy," promoting self-determination through the Fourteen Points, and attempting to create the League of Nations. Wilson's approach produced mixed results and sometimes contradicted itself with military interventions.

Comparing the Three Approaches

All three sought to expand American influence and believed America had a special world role. All were willing to intervene in Latin America. However, their methods differed: Roosevelt used military threat, Taft used economic leverage, Wilson used moral persuasion. Roosevelt emphasized power, Taft emphasized profit, Wilson emphasized principles. Roosevelt was most successful in achieving immediate goals, Taft least successful, and Wilson produced mixed results. Each approach had strengths and weaknesses that shaped American foreign policy.

Key terms first: Big Stick Diplomacy, Dollar Diplomacy. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick Diplomacy (1901-1909)" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy (1909-1913)" section, and what evidence supports it?		

Geographer's Lens — US.22 ~12 min

Geographers don't just find places — they explain how WHERE shapes WHAT happens. Work these like a geographer. Built on the Five Themes of Geography • C3 Dimension 2 • SSP.06 (spatial reasoning).

MOVEMENT & REGION — what's the spatial pattern?

In 1–2 sentences: is this a movement, a cluster, or a whole region? Name the direction or shape it takes on a map.

GEOGRAPHY AS A FORCE — how did location shape the outcome?

How did geography change WHAT happened — who was affected, how far or fast it spread, or who was left out? Use one place above as your evidence.

READ IT LIKE A SOURCE — RESPONSE CHOICE

A map is a source with a point of view. Show your thinking your way — write it, OR sketch a quick arrows-and-labels diagram: what would a map of this make CLEAR, and what would it HIDE or leave out?

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.22 ~15 min

Primary source (photograph) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



Woman suffrage parade, Wash., D.C. • Buck, G. V. (George V.), photographer • 1913

Source: Buck, G. V. (George V.), photographer. Woman suffrage parade, Wash., D.C. 1913. Photograph. Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, SSF - Women -- Politics and Suffrage -- 1913 [item] [P&P], LC-USZ62-34031 (b&w film copy neg.).
<https://www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2013648100/>. Public Domain — No Known Restrictions on Publication
<https://www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2013648100/>

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

SUPPORT OPTION

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.22 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us22-q2 • pre-field-test]

What were the key features of Taft's "Dollar Diplomacy" and how did it differ from Roosevelt's approach?

- A. Taft used American economic investment and financial leverage instead of military threat, believing economic influence was more effective and less costly, though it often still required military backup
- B. Dollar Diplomacy was identical to Big Stick Diplomacy, which does not align with the documented historical record when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- C. Taft rejected all forms of intervention, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- D. Dollar Diplomacy focused on moral values, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved

[DOK 2 • item us22-q3 • pre-field-test]

How did Wilson's "Moral Diplomacy" reflect different values and methods in American foreign policy?

- A. Wilson rejected all American intervention abroad, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, which does not align with the documented historical record, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era
- B. Wilson emphasized supporting democracy, opposing tyranny, and using moral persuasion, reflected in his Fourteen Points and League of Nations proposal, though military interventions sometimes contradicted these ideals
- C. Wilson's approach was identical to Roosevelt's, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- D. Wilson focused only on economic factors, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

[DOK 3 • item u1-us22-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Evaluate the effectiveness of these three diplomatic approaches in advancing American interests.

- A. All three approaches were equally effective, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B. None of the approaches achieved any goals, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- C. Only economic approaches were effective, which does not align with the documented historical record and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- D. Big Stick Diplomacy achieved clear results through credible force, Dollar Diplomacy struggled without military backup, and Moral Diplomacy inspired but sometimes proved unrealistic—each revealed different tools of statecraft with varying effectiveness

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.22 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Wilson's Moral Diplomacy? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us22-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

How did Theodore Roosevelt's "Big Stick" diplomacy use military strength to achieve foreign policy goals?

- A. Roosevelt avoided any military threats, which represents a common misconception about the period, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- B. Roosevelt backed diplomacy with credible military force, demonstrated by the Great White Fleet, while acting as mediator and using the Roosevelt Corollary to justify Latin American interventions
- C. Roosevelt relied only on economic pressure, which does not align with the documented historical record, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D. Roosevelt never used military demonstrations, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐ Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.23 — Causes of World War I & U.S. Neutrality

TN Academic Standard US.23: Explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality.

Lenses for this standard: History • Politics/Government

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Causes of World War I & U.S. Neutrality: Explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.23 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Militarism	The belief that a nation should maintain a strong military and be prepared to use it to defend or promote national interests; one of the M.A.I.N. causes of World War I.	Militarismo
Alliance System	The network of mutual defense agreements among European nations before WWI, creating two opposing blocs: Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain).	Sistema de Alianzas
Archduke Franz Ferdinand	Heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne whose assassination in Sarajevo on June 28, 1914, by Serbian nationalist Gavrilo Princip triggered the chain of events leading to World War I.	Archiduque Francisco Fernando
Woodrow Wilson	The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.	Woodrow Wilson
Imperialism	A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.	Imperialismo
Self-Determination	The principle that nations and peoples should have the right to decide their own political status and form of government, a key idea in Wilson's Fourteen Points.	Autodeterminación

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Militarism (MIL-ih-tuh-riz-um); Archduke Franz Ferdinand (ARCH-dook FRANTS FUR-dih-nand); Imperialism (im-PEER-ee-uh-liz-um); Self-Determination (self dee-tur-mih-NAY-shun).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Militarism	_____	_____	_____	_____
Alliance System	_____	_____	_____	_____
Archduke Franz Ferdinand	_____	_____	_____	_____
Woodrow Wilson	_____	_____	_____	_____
Imperialism	_____	_____	_____	_____
Self-Determination	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.23 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Militarism** • ES: Militarismo

Word-bank meaning to build on: The belief that a nation should maintain a strong military and be prepared to use it to defend or promote national interests; one of the M.A.I.N. causes of World War I.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Militarism” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Alliance System** • ES: Sistema de Alianzas

Word-bank meaning to build on: The network of mutual defense agreements among European nations before WWI, creating two opposing blocs: Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain).

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Alliance System” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.23 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.23 — Causes of World War I & U.S. Neutrality • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
MAIN Causes of World War I	
The Spark & Escalation	
Reasons for U.S. Neutrality	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.23

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Militarism • Alliance System • Archduke Franz Ferdinand • Woodrow Wilson • Imperialism • Self-Determination

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Analyze whether American neutrality was realistic given the country's economic and cultural ties to the belligerents.

- A. Despite official neutrality, American trade increasingly favored the Allies due to the British blockade, American loans went primarily to Allied nations, and cultural ties to Britain made true neutrality difficult
- B. Neutrality was easily maintained throughout the war, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C. America had no ties to any European nation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- D. Economic factors were irrelevant to neutrality, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.23 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

MAIN Causes of World War I

Militarism: European nations competed to build larger armies and navies, with Germany's fleet expansion threatening British supremacy. Alliances: The Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) faced the Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain), creating a web of obligations that escalated local conflicts. Imperialism: Competition for colonies in Africa and Asia, and Balkan tensions as Austria-Hungary and Russia competed for influence. Nationalism: Ethnic tensions in multi-ethnic empires, Pan-Slavism, French desire to recover Alsace-Lorraine, and Serbian aspirations threatened stability.

The Spark and Escalation

The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand (June 28, 1914) by Serbian nationalist Gavrilo Princip in Sarajevo triggered the July Crisis. Austria-Hungary declared war on Serbia, activating the alliance system. Russian mobilization in support of Serbia led to German support for Austria, then French and British entry. Germany's invasion of Belgium, violating its neutrality, brought Britain into the war, transforming a Balkan crisis into a world war within weeks.

Reasons for U.S. Neutrality

Traditional policy followed Washington's warning against foreign entanglements and the Monroe Doctrine's focus on the Western Hemisphere. Domestic considerations included German-American and Irish-American populations opposed to fighting Germany or helping Britain, profitable trade with both sides, and progressive views that European war represented old-world imperialism. Wilson hoped to serve as a neutral mediator, promoting "peace without victory." Practical challenges soon emerged: the British blockade interfered with trade to Central Powers while German submarine warfare threatened American ships and lives.

Key terms first: Militarism, Alliance System. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "MAIN Causes of World War I" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "The Spark and Escalation" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Reasons for U.S. Neutrality" section, and what evidence supports it?		

Geographer's Lens — US.23 ⌚ ~12 min

Geographers don't just find places — they explain how WHERE shapes WHAT happens. Work these like a geographer. Built on the Five Themes of Geography • C3 Dimension 2 • SSP.06 (spatial reasoning).

THE PLACES — then explain why geography put them there

World War I split Europe into two sides. Use the list below to map the Allied Powers, the Central Powers, and the Western Front where most of the fighting happened.

Place	Where	What happened (given)	Why HERE? (your analysis)
Britain, France, Russia	Western & Eastern Europe	the Allied Powers	_____
Germany, Austria-Hungary, Ottoman Empire	Central Europe	the Central Powers	_____
The Western Front	France & Belgium	trench warfare; where most fighting happened	_____

MOVEMENT & REGION — what's the spatial pattern?

In 1–2 sentences: is this a movement, a cluster, or a whole region? Name the direction or shape it takes on a map.

GEOGRAPHY AS A FORCE — how did location shape the outcome?

How did geography change WHAT happened — who was affected, how far or fast it spread, or who was left out? Use one place above as your evidence.

READ IT LIKE A SOURCE — RESPONSE CHOICE

A map is a source with a point of view. Show your thinking your way — write it, OR sketch a quick arrows-and-labels diagram: what would a map of this make CLEAR, and what would it HIDE or leave out?

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.23 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

REPORT TO THE BELGIAN GOVERNMENT

“In spite of these wholesale acts of burning and destruction, it seems proved that isolated cases of destruction of a more monstrous character occurred. Leuven was deliberately and systematically burned. The Palace of Justice, the University”

Source: Bryce Committee, May 1915. Committee, Bryce. "Report to the Belgian Government." May 1915. Avalon Project, Yale Law School, avalon.law.yale.edu/20th_century/bryce.asp. Public domain. https://avalon.law.yale.edu/20th_century/bryce.asp

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

SUPPORT OPTION

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

EXTEND & RE-ENGAGE (open to all)

Push past the document — corroborate, contextualize, and judge its meaning.

Historian move	Your response
Corroborate — what other source would confirm or complicate this one?	
Contextualize — what was happening at the time that explains it?	
So what? — why does this source still matter?	

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.23 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us23-q2 • pre-field-test]

What specific events triggered the outbreak of war in Europe in 1914?

- A. The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand activated the alliance system, with Austria-Hungary attacking Serbia, Russia mobilizing, Germany supporting Austria, and France and Britain entering
- B. War began without any triggering event, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C. The United States started the war, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era
- D. Economic competition alone caused the war, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period

[DOK 2 • item us23-q3 • pre-field-test]

Why did the United States initially choose to remain neutral in the European conflict?

- A. America had no interest in European affairs, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- B. Traditional policy against entanglements, diverse immigrant populations with divided loyalties, profitable trade with both sides, and Wilson's hope to mediate peace all supported neutrality
- C. The Constitution required neutrality, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- D. America supported Germany from the start, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era

[DOK 3 • item u1-us23-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Analyze whether American neutrality was realistic given the country's economic and cultural ties to the belligerents.

- A. Despite official neutrality, American trade increasingly favored the Allies due to the British blockade, American loans went primarily to Allied nations, and cultural ties to Britain made true neutrality difficult
- B. Neutrality was easily maintained throughout the war, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C. America had no ties to any European nation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- D. Economic factors were irrelevant to neutrality, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.23 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us23-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

How did militarism, alliances, imperialism, and nationalism (MAIN) create conditions for World War I?

- A. Only one factor caused World War I, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B. These factors prevented war, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors and fails to account for key developments in the broader context, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C. Military buildups created tension, alliances turned local conflicts into continental wars, imperial competition bred rivalry, and nationalism inflamed ethnic conflicts—together creating explosive conditions
- D. World War I began without any underlying causes, but this fails to account for the broader historical context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐

Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.24 — Reasons for American Entry into World War I

TN Academic Standard US.24: Explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including: the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations.

Lenses for this standard: History • Politics/Government

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

★ Tennessee Connection

Over 90,000 Tennesseans served in World War I. Alvin C. York of Pall Mall in Fentress County became the most decorated American soldier of the war. Tennessee's military camps, including Camp Pike, trained thousands of soldiers for deployment.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Reasons for American Entry into World War I: Explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including: the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.24 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Unrestricted Submarine Warfare	Germany's policy of attacking any ship—military or civilian—in the war zone around Britain without warning, which helped draw the United States into WWI.	Guerra Submarina Sin Restricciones
Zimmermann Telegram	A 1917 secret message from Germany to Mexico proposing a military alliance against the United States, intercepted by the British and used to justify American entry into WWI.	Telegrama Zimmermann
RMS Lusitania	British passenger ship torpedoed by a German U-boat on May 7, 1915, killing 1,198 people including 128 Americans, turning American public opinion against Germany.	RMS Lusitania
Woodrow Wilson	The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.	Woodrow Wilson
Militarism	The belief that a nation should maintain a strong military and be prepared to use it to defend or promote national interests; one of the M.A.I.N. causes of World War I.	Militarismo
Alliance System	The network of mutual defense agreements among European nations before WWI, creating two opposing blocs: Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain).	Sistema de Alianzas

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Unrestricted Submarine Warfare (un-ree-STRIK-ted SUB-muh-reen WOR-fair); Zimmermann Telegram (ZIM-er-mahn TEL-uh-gram); RMS Lusitania (loo-suh-TAY-nee-uh); Militarism (MIL-ih-tuh-riz-um).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Unrestricted Submarine Warfare	_____	_____	_____	_____
Zimmermann Telegram	_____	_____	_____	_____
RMS Lusitania	_____	_____	_____	_____
Woodrow Wilson	_____	_____	_____	_____
Militarism	_____	_____	_____	_____
Alliance System	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.24 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Unrestricted Submarine Warfare** · ES: Guerra Submarina Sin Restricciones

Word-bank meaning to build on: Germany's policy of attacking any ship—military or civilian—in the war zone around Britain without warning, which helped draw the United States into WWI.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Unrestricted Submarine Warfare” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Zimmermann Telegram** · ES: Telegrama Zimmermann

Word-bank meaning to build on: A 1917 secret message from Germany to Mexico proposing a military alliance against the United States, intercepted by the British and used to justify American entry into WWI.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Zimmermann Telegram” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.24 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.24 — Reasons for American Entry into World War I • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Unrestricted Submarine Warfare	
The Zimmermann Telegram	
Defense of Democracy & Economics	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.24

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Unrestricted Submarine Warfare • Zimmermann Telegram • RMS Lusitania • Woodrow Wilson • Militarism
• Alliance System

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Evaluate the relative importance of economic interests versus idealistic goals in America's decision for war.

- A. Only economic factors mattered, but this fails to account for the broader historical context when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B. Both factors were important: economic ties to the Allies and threatened trade provided practical motivation, while democratic ideals gave moral justification—neither alone fully explains American entry
- C. Only idealism drove the decision, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and fails to account for key developments in the broader context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D. Neither economic nor idealistic factors played any role, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.24 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Unrestricted Submarine Warfare

German U-boats would sink any ship entering the war zone around Britain without warning, violating international law and threatening neutral shipping. The Lusitania sinking (May 7, 1915) killed 1,198 including 128 Americans, shocking the public. Germany's Sussex Pledge (1916) promised warnings before attacks, but in February 1917, Germany resumed unrestricted submarine warfare, believing it could win before America mobilized. Wilson severed diplomatic relations and asked Congress to arm merchant ships.

The Zimmermann Telegram

In January 1917, German Foreign Minister Arthur Zimmermann proposed an alliance with Mexico if the U.S. entered the war, promising return of Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona. British intelligence decoded the telegram and shared it with America. Public reaction was outrage, especially in the Southwest, as it made German threat seem immediate and direct. The telegram convinced many Americans that Germany posed a direct threat to U.S. territory and helped build congressional support for war.

Defense of Democracy and Economic Motivations

Wilson's rhetoric framed the war as a crusade to "make the world safe for democracy," portraying it as a struggle between democratic and autocratic systems. The Russian Revolution (March 1917), which overthrew the Tsar, made it easier to claim the Allies fought for democracy. Wilson's Fourteen Points emphasized democratic principles and self-determination. Economic factors also mattered: American banks had loaned over \$2 billion to the Allies, trade patterns favored the Allies, and war production created jobs and profits. German submarine attacks threatened these economic interests.

Key terms first: Unrestricted Submarine Warfare, Zimmermann Telegram. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "Unrestricted Submarine Warfare" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "The Zimmermann Telegram" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Defense of Democracy and Economic Motivations" section, and what evidence supports it?		

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.24 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

SUSSEX PLEDGE

“The German Government is prepared to do its utmost to confine the operations of war for the rest of its duration to the fighting forces of the belligerents, thereby also insuring the freedom of the seas... German naval forces have received ”

Source: German Government, May 4, 1916. Government, German. "Sussex Pledge." May 4, 1916. Avalon Project, Yale Law School, avalon.law.yale.edu/20th_century/sussex.asp. Public domain. https://avalon.law.yale.edu/20th_century/sussex.asp

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

SUPPORT OPTION

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

EXTEND & RE-ENGAGE (open to all)

Push past the document — corroborate, contextualize, and judge its meaning.

Historian move	Your response
Corroborate — what other source would confirm or complicate this one?	
Contextualize — what was happening at the time that explains it?	
So what? — why does this source still matter?	

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.24 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us24-q2 • pre-field-test]

What was the Zimmermann Telegram, and why did it outrage American public opinion?

- A. Germany proposed an alliance with Mexico offering to return Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona, making German threat seem direct and immediate to Americans
- B. It was a routine diplomatic communication, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C. It was a peace proposal from Germany, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- D. Americans did not react to the telegram, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

[DOK 2 • item us24-q3 • pre-field-test]

How did Wilson use the goal of "making the world safe for democracy" to justify American entry?

- A. Wilson never mentioned democracy, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- B. Wilson framed the war as a moral crusade against autocracy, especially after the Russian Revolution removed the Tsar from the Allied side, making it a fight for democratic values
- C. Wilson emphasized only economic reasons, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- D. Democracy played no role in war justifications, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

[DOK 3 • item u1-us24-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Evaluate the relative importance of economic interests versus idealistic goals in America's decision for war.

- A. Only economic factors mattered, but this fails to account for the broader historical context when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B. Both factors were important: economic ties to the Allies and threatened trade provided practical motivation, while democratic ideals gave moral justification—neither alone fully explains American entry
- C. Only idealism drove the decision, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and fails to account for key developments in the broader context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D. Neither economic nor idealistic factors played any role, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.24 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us24-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

How did German submarine warfare, particularly unrestricted submarine warfare, push America toward war?

- A. Submarine warfare had no effect on American opinion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B. Germany never used submarines against American ships, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C. Americans supported German submarine warfare, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- D. Attacks like the Lusitania sinking killed Americans and violated international law, and resumption of unrestricted warfare in 1917 threatened all American shipping, leading Wilson to sever relations

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐ Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.25 — Key Figures and Developments in World War I

TN Academic Standard US.25: Identify and explain the impact of the following on World War I: Trench warfare, Use of new weapons and technology, Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, Alvin C. York. (TCA)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can identify and explain the impact of trench warfare, new weapons and technology, the Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, and Alvin C. York on World War I.

Lenses for this standard: History • Geography • Tennessee Connection

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

★ Tennessee Connection

Alvin York of Fentress County, Tennessee, became one of the most decorated American soldiers of World War I. Sergeant York captured 132 German soldiers almost single-handedly in the Meuse-Argonne Offensive of October 1918.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Key Figures and Developments in World War I: Identify and explain the impact of the following on World War I: Trench warfare, Use of new weapons and technology, Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, Alvin C. York. (TCA). Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.25 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Trench Warfare	A type of combat in which soldiers fight from elaborate systems of trenches, creating a stalemate where neither side could advance; characteristic of WWI's Western Front.	Guerra de Trincheras
No Man's Land	The dangerous, exposed ground between opposing trenches in WWI, filled with barbed wire, shell craters, and dead bodies.	Tierra de Nadie
John J. Pershing	Commander of the American Expeditionary Forces (AEF) in WWI, who insisted on keeping American troops together as an independent force rather than integrating them into Allied armies.	John J. Pershing
Harlem Hellfighters	The 369th Infantry Regiment, a highly decorated African American unit that fought with the French army in WWI, spending 191 days in combat—more than any other American unit.	Harlem Hellfighters
Alvin C. York	A Tennessee soldier who became one of WWI's most decorated American heroes after single-handedly capturing 132 German soldiers in the Meuse-Argonne Offensive.	Alvin C. York
Meuse-Argonne Offensive	The largest and deadliest American battle of WWI (September-November 1918), where 1.2 million U.S. soldiers fought, helping to end the war but costing 26,000 American lives.	Ofensiva Meuse-Argonne

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: John J. Pershing (PUR-shing); Harlem Hellfighters (HAR-lem HEL-fy-terz); Meuse-Argonne Offensive (MYOOZ ar-GONN uh-FEN-siv).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Trench Warfare	_____	_____	_____	_____
No Man's Land	_____	_____	_____	_____
John J. Pershing	_____	_____	_____	_____
Harlem Hellfighters	_____	_____	_____	_____
Alvin C. York	_____	_____	_____	_____
Meuse-Argonne Offensive	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.25 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Trench Warfare** • ES: Guerra de Trincheras

Word-bank meaning to build on: A type of combat in which soldiers fight from elaborate systems of trenches, creating a stalemate where neither side could advance; characteristic of WWI's Western Front.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Trench Warfare” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **No Man's Land** • ES: Tierra de Nadie

Word-bank meaning to build on: The dangerous, exposed ground between opposing trenches in WWI, filled with barbed wire, shell craters, and dead bodies.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “No Man's Land” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.25 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.25 — Key Figures and Developments in World War I • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Trench Warfare & New Technology	
Herbert Hoover & John J. Pershing	
Harlem Hellfighters & Alvin C. York	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.25

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Trench Warfare • No Man's Land • John J. Pershing • Harlem Hellfighters • Alvin C. York • Meuse-Argonne Offensive

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Analyze how technological innovations and individual heroism both shaped the American experience in WWI.

- A. Technology was irrelevant to the American experience, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B. Individual heroism was unimportant in modern war, which does not reflect the consensus among historians when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- C. New weapons created the brutal conditions Americans faced while individual heroes like York and the Hellfighters showed how Americans adapted and excelled despite the horrors of modern warfare
- D. Americans were not affected by new technologies, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.25 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Trench Warfare and New Technologies

Trenches stretched from the English Channel to Switzerland, creating a stalemate where neither side could achieve breakthrough. Conditions included mud, rats, disease, and constant threat of death. New weapons transformed warfare: machine guns made frontal assaults deadly, poison gas (chlorine, phosgene, mustard) caused horrific casualties, massive artillery bombardments destroyed landscapes, aircraft evolved from reconnaissance to fighters and bombers, and tanks helped break the stalemate. These innovations made WWI uniquely destructive.

Herbert Hoover and John J. Pershing

Herbert Hoover headed the Commission for Relief in Belgium (1914-1917) and served as U.S. Food Administrator (1917-1919). He organized massive humanitarian relief and coordinated American food production through voluntary conservation ("Hooverize"), ensuring adequate supplies without rationing. General John J. Pershing commanded the American Expeditionary Forces, insisting on maintaining a separate American command rather than integrating with Allied forces. He emphasized open warfare tactics and maintained high morale, supporting major offensives that helped end the war.

Harlem Hellfighters and Alvin C. York

The Harlem Hellfighters (369th Infantry Regiment) were African American soldiers from New York who served with French forces due to American military segregation. They spent 191 days in combat—longer than any other American unit—and earned many French military honors including the Croix de Guerre. Their service demonstrated African American military capability despite discrimination. Alvin C. York, a Tennessee farmer and former conscientious objector, became the most famous American soldier when he single-handedly captured 132 German soldiers in the Argonne Forest. He received the Medal of Honor and symbolized American frontier values and individual heroism.

Key terms first: Trench Warfare, No Man's Land. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "Trench Warfare and New Technologies" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Herbert Hoover and John J. Pershing" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Harlem Hellfighters and Alvin C. York" section, and what evidence supports it?		

Geographer's Lens — US.25 ~12 min

Geographers don't just find places — they explain how WHERE shapes WHAT happens. Work these like a geographer. Built on the Five Themes of Geography • C3 Dimension 2 • SSP.06 (spatial reasoning).

MOVEMENT & REGION — what's the spatial pattern?

In 1–2 sentences: is this a movement, a cluster, or a whole region? Name the direction or shape it takes on a map.

GEOGRAPHY AS A FORCE — how did location shape the outcome?

How did geography change WHAT happened — who was affected, how far or fast it spread, or who was left out? Use one place above as your evidence.

READ IT LIKE A SOURCE — RESPONSE CHOICE

A map is a source with a point of view. Show your thinking your way — write it, OR sketch a quick arrows-and-labels diagram: what would a map of this make CLEAR, and what would it HIDE or leave out?

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.25 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

HENRY JOHNSON MEDAL OF HONOR CITATION

“While on sentry duty during the night, Private Johnson and another Soldier were attacked by a German raiding party of at least 12 soldiers. Despite sustaining significant wounds, Private Johnson mounted a one-man retaliation, killing several”

Source: U.S. Army, 1918 (posthumously awarded 2015). Army, U.S.. "Henry Johnson Medal of Honor Citation." 1918 (posthumously awarded 2015). National Archives, www.archives.gov/research/military/ww1. Public domain.
<https://www.archives.gov/research/military/ww1>

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

SUPPORT OPTION

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

EXTEND & RE-ENGAGE (open to all)

Push past the document — corroborate, contextualize, and judge its meaning.

Historian move	Your response
Corroborate — what other source would confirm or complicate this one?	
Contextualize — what was happening at the time that explains it?	
So what? — why does this source still matter?	

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.25 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us25-q2 • pre-field-test]

What contributions did Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, and Alvin C. York make to the American war effort?

- A. Hoover organized food production and relief, Pershing commanded American forces maintaining independence from Allied command, and York became a hero through individual combat achievement
- B. None of these figures contributed to the war, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C. They all served in the same military unit, although historical sources do not support this conclusion despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- D. Their contributions were limited to the home front, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, which does not align with the documented historical record

[DOK 2 • item us25-q3 • pre-field-test]

How did the Harlem Hellfighters demonstrate African American military capabilities despite facing discrimination?

- A. African Americans did not serve in World War I, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- B. Serving with French forces due to segregation, they spent more time in combat than any American unit and earned French military honors, proving their courage despite American racial discrimination
- C. They served only in support roles, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D. Their service was not recognized, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era

[DOK 3 • item u1-us25-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Analyze how technological innovations and individual heroism both shaped the American experience in WWI.

- A. Technology was irrelevant to the American experience, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B. Individual heroism was unimportant in modern war, which does not reflect the consensus among historians when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- C. New weapons created the brutal conditions Americans faced while individual heroes like York and the Hellfighters showed how Americans adapted and excelled despite the horrors of modern warfare
- D. Americans were not affected by new technologies, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.25 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — identify and explain the impact of trench warfare, new weapons and technology, the Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, and Alvin C. York on World War I? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us25-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

How did trench warfare and new military technologies change the nature of combat in World War I?

- A. Trenches created deadly stalemate while machine guns, poison gas, artillery, aircraft, and tanks made warfare far more destructive, resulting in massive casualties for minimal gains
- B. Combat remained unchanged from previous wars, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- C. New technologies ended the war quickly, but this fails to account for the broader historical context when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- D. Trench warfare was only used briefly, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐

Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.26 — World War I Home Front

TN Academic Standard US.26: Analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including: Role played by women and minorities, Voluntary rationing, Committee on Public Information, Opposition by conscientious objectors, Schenck v. United States decision.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including the role of women and minorities, voluntary rationing, the Committee on Public Information, conscientious objectors, and the Schenck v. United States decision.

Lenses for this standard: History • Economics • Culture

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

★ Tennessee Connection

Tennessee's home front during WWI saw the expansion of military training facilities and war industries. Nashville, Memphis, and Chattanooga served as training and supply hubs. Tennessee women organized Red Cross chapters and Liberty Bond drives across the state.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

World War I Home Front: Analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including: Role played by women and minorities, Voluntary rationing, Committee on Public Information, Opposition by conscientious objectors, Schenck v. United States decision. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.26 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Committee on Public Information	A government propaganda agency created in 1917 to build support for WWI through posters, films, speeches, and censorship of anti-war messages.	Comité de Información Pública
Espionage and Sedition Acts	Laws passed in 1917-1918 making it illegal to interfere with the draft, criticize the government or war effort, or encourage disloyalty, severely limiting free speech during WWI.	Leyes de Espionaje y Sedición
Schenck v. United States	A 1919 Supreme Court case that upheld the Espionage Act, ruling that speech creating a "clear and present danger" could be restricted, even in peacetime.	Schenck v. Estados Unidos
George Creel	Journalist who headed the Committee on Public Information during WWI, creating America's first large-scale government propaganda campaign to build support for the war.	George Creel
Armistice Day	November 11, 1918—the day WWI fighting ended at 11:00 AM when Germany signed an armistice agreement; now commemorated as Veterans Day in the United States.	Día del Armisticio
Woodrow Wilson	The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.	Woodrow Wilson

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Committee on Public Information (kuh-MIT-ee on PUB-lik in-fer-MAY-shun); Espionage and Sedition Acts (ES-pee-uh-nahzh and suh-DISH-un akts); Schenck v. United States (SHENK versus united states); George Creel (KREEL).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Committee on Public Information	_____	_____	_____	_____
Espionage and Sedition Acts	_____	_____	_____	_____
Schenck v. United States	_____	_____	_____	_____
George Creel	_____	_____	_____	_____
Armistice Day	_____	_____	_____	_____
Woodrow Wilson	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.26 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Committee on Public Information** • ES: Comité de Información Pública

Word-bank meaning to build on: A government propaganda agency created in 1917 to build support for WWI through posters, films, speeches, and censorship of anti-war messages.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Committee on Public Information” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Espionage and Sedition Acts** • ES: Leyes de Espionaje y Sedición

Word-bank meaning to build on: Laws passed in 1917-1918 making it illegal to interfere with the draft, criticize the government or war effort, or encourage disloyalty, severely limiting free speech during WWI.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Espionage and Sedition Acts” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.26 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.26 — World War I Home Front • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Expanded Federal Power	
Economic Effects & Rationing	
Women & Minorities	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.26

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Committee on Public Information • Espionage and Sedition Acts • Schenck v. United States • George Creel • Armistice Day • Woodrow Wilson

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Analyze how the Schenck v. United States decision balanced national security needs with First Amendment rights.

- A. The Court fully protected free speech, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B. The Court declared all wartime speech restrictions unconstitutional, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C. The case had no impact on free speech law, but the historical record tells a more complex story, which represents a common misconception about this historical period and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D. The Court ruled speech creating "clear and present danger" could be restricted, upholding Schenck's conviction and establishing that First Amendment rights are not absolute during wartime emergencies

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.26 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Political Changes and Expanded Federal Power

The federal government assumed unprecedented control through agencies like the War Industries Board (coordinating production), Selective Service Act (drafting 24 million men), and the Espionage Act (1917) and Sedition Act (1918), which restricted free speech. Executive authority expanded dramatically, and the government prosecuted anti-war activists, socialists, and German-Americans who were seen as disloyal.

Economic Effects and Voluntary Rationing

Herbert Hoover's Food Administration promoted voluntary conservation through "Meatless Mondays" and "Wheatless Wednesdays" rather than mandatory rationing. Victory Gardens produced 20% of vegetables. Liberty Bonds raised \$21 billion to finance the war. Price controls regulated essential commodities while factories converted to military production, creating economic growth and full employment, though inflation also rose.

Women and Minorities

Women entered factories, munitions plants, and previously male-dominated jobs, serving as nurses and support personnel in the military. Their war service strengthened arguments for suffrage. The Great Migration brought 500,000 African Americans north for industrial jobs, though they faced continued discrimination. 400,000 African Americans served in segregated military units. Mexican Americans and Native Americans also contributed, though all minorities faced ongoing prejudice despite their service.

Propaganda, Conscientious Objectors, and Civil Liberties

George Creel's Committee on Public Information used posters, films, pamphlets, and "Four Minute Men" speakers to build support and promote anti-German sentiment. About 65,000 conscientious objectors claimed exemption based on religious or moral beliefs, facing imprisonment or alternative service. The Supreme Court's *Schenck v. United States* (1919) decision upheld restrictions on free speech, establishing the "clear and present danger" test. Justice Holmes wrote that free speech would not protect "falsely shouting fire in a theatre."

Key terms first: Committee on Public Information, Espionage and Sedition Acts. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "Political Changes and Expanded Federal Power" section, and what evidence supports it?	 	
What is the main idea of the "Economic Effects and Voluntary Rationing" section, and what evidence supports it?	 	
What is the main idea of the "Women and Minorities" section, and what evidence supports it?	 	

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.26 ~15 min

Primary source (political cartoon) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



The duty of the hour; - to save her not only from Spain, but from a worse fate / Dalrymple. • Dalrymple, Louis, 1866-1905 • 1898

Source: "The duty of the hour; - to save her not only from Spain, but from a worse fate / Dalrymple." Political cartoon, chromolithograph. 1898.

Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, Illus. in AP101.P7 1898 (Case X) [P&P], LC-DIG-ppmsca-28700.

<https://www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2012647563/>. Public Domain — No Known Restrictions on Publication

<https://www.loc.gov/research-centers/prints-and-photographs/researcher-resources/copyright-and-rights-and-restrictions-information/>

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	
SUPPORT OPTION	
Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.	
CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN	
Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____	

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.26 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us26-q2 • pre-field-test]

What new opportunities did the war create for women and minorities, and what limitations did they still face?

- A. Women gained industrial jobs and strengthened suffrage arguments while African Americans found northern factory jobs, though both faced continued discrimination and were expected to return to prewar roles
- B. No new opportunities emerged, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- C. Women and minorities faced no discrimination, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- D. Only men participated in the war effort, which represents a common misconception about the period, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

[DOK 2 • item us26-q3 • pre-field-test]

How did the Committee on Public Information shape public opinion and promote wartime unity?

- A. The government did not attempt to influence opinion, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B. George Creel's CPI used posters, films, pamphlets, and speakers to build support, promote patriotism, and encourage anti-German sentiment, establishing modern government propaganda techniques
- C. Only newspapers shaped opinion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D. The CPI promoted neutrality, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality

[DOK 3 • item u1-us26-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Analyze how the Schenck v. United States decision balanced national security needs with First Amendment rights.

- A. The Court fully protected free speech, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B. The Court declared all wartime speech restrictions unconstitutional, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C. The case had no impact on free speech law, but the historical record tells a more complex story, which represents a common misconception about this historical period and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D. The Court ruled speech creating "clear and present danger" could be restricted, upholding Schenck's conviction and establishing that First Amendment rights are not absolute during wartime emergencies

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.26 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including the role of women and minorities, voluntary rationing, the Committee on Public Information, conscientious objectors, and the Schenck v. United States decision? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us26-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

How did World War I expand federal government power over the American economy and society?

- A. Government power decreased during the war, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B. New agencies controlled production, the draft conscripted millions, and the Espionage and Sedition Acts restricted speech, giving the federal government unprecedented authority
- C. Only the military expanded, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- D. State governments controlled the war effort, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐

Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Standard US.27 — Wilson's Fourteen Points and League of Nations

TN Academic Standard US.27: Analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics.

Lenses for this standard: Politics/Government • History • Culture

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Same rigor for everyone: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER.

UDL and MTSS give you flexible ways in — they never lower the bar.

Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page.

★ Tennessee Connection

Cordell Hull of Pickett County, Tennessee — who would later champion international cooperation as Secretary of State and help found the United Nations — was serving in Congress during the League of Nations debate. His early experiences with Wilson's internationalism shaped his lifelong commitment to multilateral diplomacy.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it?

HOOK — think before you dig in

Wilson's Fourteen Points and League of Nations: Analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics. Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

PREVIEW & PREDICT

Which learning target will be hardest, and why? Connect it to the unit's big question: who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — US.27 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Fourteen Points	Woodrow Wilson's 1918 peace plan emphasizing self-determination, free trade, open diplomacy, disarmament, and the creation of a League of Nations.	Catorce Puntos
Treaty of Versailles	The 1919 peace treaty ending WWI that blamed Germany for the war, imposed massive reparations, stripped Germany of territory, and created the League of Nations.	Tratado de Versalles
League of Nations	An international organization created after WWI to prevent future wars through collective security and diplomacy; the United States never joined due to Senate opposition.	Liga de Naciones
Henry Cabot Lodge	Republican Senator from Massachusetts who led opposition to the Treaty of Versailles and League of Nations, fearing it would limit U.S. sovereignty and entangle America in European conflicts.	Henry Cabot Lodge
Self-Determination	The principle that nations and peoples should have the right to decide their own political status and form of government, a key idea in Wilson's Fourteen Points.	Autodeterminación
Woodrow Wilson	The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.	Woodrow Wilson

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Fourteen Points (FOR-teen points); Treaty of Versailles (TREE-tee of ver-SIGH); League of Nations (leeg of NAY-shunz); Henry Cabot Lodge (KAB-ut lodj); Self-Determination (self dee-tur-mih-NAY-shun).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Fourteen Points	_____	_____	_____	_____
Treaty of Versailles	_____	_____	_____	_____
League of Nations	_____	_____	_____	_____
Henry Cabot Lodge	_____	_____	_____	_____
Self-Determination	_____	_____	_____	_____
Woodrow Wilson	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — US.27 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete each studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM 1 **Fourteen Points** • ES: Catorce Puntos

Word-bank meaning to build on: Woodrow Wilson's 1918 peace plan emphasizing self-determination, free trade, open diplomacy, disarmament, and the creation of a League of Nations.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Fourteen Points” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 **Treaty of Versailles** • ES: Tratado de Versailles

Word-bank meaning to build on: The 1919 peace treaty ending WWI that blamed Germany for the war, imposed massive reparations, stripped Germany of territory, and created the League of Nations.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Treaty of Versailles” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write or sketch how one leads to or affects another.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — US.27 ~20 min

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

US.27 — Wilson's Fourteen Points and League of Nations • These notes capture the direct-teaching content and the Close Read for this standard.

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Cues (tied to your learning targets)	My notes
Wilson's Fourteen Points	
Causes of U.S. Rejection	
Impact on World Politics	
Key terms →	
DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL • another way in) Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.	

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — US.27

MORE NOTES / DIAGRAMS

Continue your notes here, add a quick sketch, or map how the ideas connect.

Key terms to list

Fourteen Points • Treaty of Versailles • League of Nations • Henry Cabot Lodge • Self-Determination • Woodrow Wilson

Summary — In your own words (2–3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK • one question

Evaluate whether Wilson's idealistic approach to international relations was realistic for the post-war world.

- A. Wilson's vision of collective security and self-determination was inspiring but faced practical obstacles including Senate opposition, European power politics, and the difficulty of enforcing peace without American commitment
- B. Wilson's approach was completely realistic, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C. Idealism played no role in Wilson's thinking, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D. The League succeeded despite American absence, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ 1

My 12–15 word headline for this standard

Activity 4 — Close Read — US.27 ~15 min

Reading type: History Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH — read one chunk at a time

Wilson's Fourteen Points

Announced January 8, 1918, Wilson's Fourteen Points outlined his vision for post-war peace. Key principles included: open diplomacy (ending secret treaties), freedom of the seas, free trade, arms reduction, impartial adjustment of colonial claims, and specific territorial settlements based on self-determination. The fourteenth point called for a League of Nations to guarantee political independence and territorial integrity for all nations. Wilson aimed for "peace without victory" that would not create resentment leading to future wars.

Causes of U.S. Rejection of the League

The Senate rejected League membership for several reasons. Senator Henry Cabot Lodge and "Reservationists" wanted amendments protecting U.S. sovereignty, particularly regarding Article X, which required members to defend each other against aggression. "Irreconcilables" opposed any membership. Critics worried the League would entangle America in foreign conflicts and override congressional war powers. Wilson's refusal to compromise, his stroke during his speaking tour, and partisan politics all contributed. The Senate rejected the Treaty of Versailles and League membership in 1919 and 1920.

Impact on World Politics

American absence fundamentally weakened the League of Nations. Without U.S. participation, the League lacked the power to enforce its decisions. Britain and France dominated a weakened organization that proved unable to prevent aggression in the 1930s. The League failed to stop Japan in Manchuria (1931), Italy in Ethiopia (1935), or Germany's expansion. Wilson's idealistic vision remained unfulfilled, and American isolationism contributed to conditions that led to World War II. The failure informed later creation of the United Nations with stronger American involvement.

Key terms first: Fourteen Points, Treaty of Versailles. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB — for each question: quote the EVIDENCE from the passage above, then write YOUR ANSWER (or answer aloud / diagram it).

Text-dependent question	Evidence from the passage	Your answer (what it shows)
What is the main idea of the "Wilson's Fourteen Points" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Causes of U.S. Rejection of the League" section, and what evidence supports it?		
What is the main idea of the "Impact on World Politics" section, and what evidence supports it?		

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — US.27 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

TREATY OF VERSAILLES, ARTICLE 231 (WAR GUILT CLAUSE)

“The Allied and Associated Governments affirm and Germany accepts the responsibility of Germany and her allies for causing all the loss and damage to which the Allied and Associated Governments and their nationals have been subjected as a co”

Source: Allied Powers, June 28, 1919. Powers, Allied. "Treaty of Versailles, Article 231 (War Guilt Clause)." June 28, 1919. Avalon Project, Yale Law School, avalon.law.yale.edu/imt/partviii.asp. Public domain. <https://avalon.law.yale.edu/imt/partviii.asp>

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

SUPPORT OPTION

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

EXTEND & RE-ENGAGE (open to all)

Push past the document — corroborate, contextualize, and judge its meaning.

Historian move	Your response
Corroborate — what other source would confirm or complicate this one?	
Contextualize — what was happening at the time that explains it?	
So what? — why does this source still matter?	

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — US.27 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 2 • item us27-q2 • pre-field-test]

Why did the United States Senate reject American membership in the League of Nations?

- A. Concerns about sovereignty, Article X commitments to defend other nations, fear of foreign entanglements, Wilson's refusal to compromise, and partisan opposition led to rejection
- B. The Senate unanimously supported the League, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- C. Americans supported isolationism without debate, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D. Only economic factors caused rejection, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

[DOK 2 • item us27-q3 • pre-field-test]

How did American absence affect the League of Nations' ability to maintain international peace?

- A. American absence had no effect, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- B. Without U.S. power and resources, the League could not enforce decisions, failed to stop aggression in Manchuria, Ethiopia, and Germany, and proved unable to prevent World War II
- C. The League was stronger without America, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- D. America joined the League secretly, but the historical record tells a more complex story, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research

[DOK 3 • item u1-us27-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

Evaluate whether Wilson's idealistic approach to international relations was realistic for the post-war world.

- A. Wilson's vision of collective security and self-determination was inspiring but faced practical obstacles including Senate opposition, European power politics, and the difficulty of enforcing peace without American commitment
- B. Wilson's approach was completely realistic, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C. Idealism played no role in Wilson's thinking, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D. The League succeeded despite American absence, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — US.27 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER — as the U.S. became a world power and went to war, who decided, who benefited, and who bore the costs?

Jot quick notes from THIS standard: Who benefited? • Who bore the costs? • Who decided?

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

SELF-CHECK (CER rubric — see Toolkit)

Is my claim defensible? • TWO specific pieces of evidence? • Does my reasoning explain HOW the evidence proves the claim?

EXIT TICKET — before you leave [item us27-q1 • DOK 2 • pre-field-test]

What were the main principles of Wilson's Fourteen Points, and how did they reflect his vision for post-war peace?

- A. Wilson supported punishing Germany harshly, which does not align with the documented historical record and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B. Wilson's plan focused only on territorial changes, but the historical record tells a more complex story, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C. Wilson promoted open diplomacy, free trade, arms reduction, self-determination, and a League of Nations to prevent future wars through collective security rather than harsh punishment
- D. The Fourteen Points supported American isolation, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

Show what you know (your choice): mark the best answer, say it, or explain it — then rate how sure you are: ☐ Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Got it

Answer key and next steps are in the Teacher Guide.

Your Tennessee Connection

TENNESSEE CONNECTION • SERGEANT ALVIN C. YORK

Over 90,000 Tennesseans served in World War I. Alvin C. York of Pall Mall, Fentress County — a farmer who first sought conscientious-objector status — became one of the most decorated American soldiers of the war. On October 8, 1918, in the Argonne Forest, he helped capture 132 German soldiers and earned the Medal of Honor. Tennessee's "Volunteer State" tradition (US.21) runs straight through the war (US.24–US.25). Cordell Hull of Pickett County later helped found the United Nations and won the Nobel Peace Prize (US.27).

Reflect (RESPONSE CHOICE): How does a local story change the way you understand a national event? Answer by writing, recording, or diagramming.

Local History Investigation

Industrialization touched Tennessee too — railroads, mines, mills, and the people who worked them. Investigate one local connection and record what you find.

Prompt	Your findings
A person, place, or industry from this era near me	
One source I could check (library, TSLA, family, museum)	
Who benefited / who bore the costs, locally	
One question I still have	

Progress Tracker & Cumulative Review

Track your Progress Check result for each standard and note one thing to revisit.

Standard	Progress Check (✓ / reteach)	One thing to revisit
US.19	 	
US.20	 	
US.21	 	
US.22	 	
US.23	 	
US.24	 	
US.25	 	

Standard	Progress Check (✓ / reteach)	One thing to revisit
US.26		
US.27		

Optional Extension Bank (higher-DOK, open to all)

Any student may choose an extension. These are EXTENSION, not a track.

US.19: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.20: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.21: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including the annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, and access to Cuba? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.22: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Wilson's Moral Diplomacy? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.23: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.24: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.25: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — identify and explain the impact of trench warfare, new weapons and technology, the Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, and Alvin C. York on World War I? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.26: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including the role of women and minorities, voluntary rationing, the Committee on Public Information, conscientious objectors, and the Schenck v. United States decision? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

US.27: Using this standard, take a position on the central question — analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics? Support your claim with two pieces of evidence from the passage and explain your reasoning.

Think Like a Test-Writer (unit review — open to all)

You met a quick “think like a test-writer” prompt in every standard. Here is the full how-to, once, plus room to write your best questions for the whole unit.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from this unit] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

Standard	Your DOK-3 question	Your answer key (one sentence)
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Reusable Toolkit & Source Library

Written Response Rubric (CER)

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains how evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear/missing	Missing/inaccurate	No reasoning

Source Library — full citations & clickable links

US.19 — Causes of American Imperialism

Queen Liliuokalani's Protest to the Annexation of Hawaii. Queen Liliuokalani, June 17, 1897. Liliuokalani, Queen. "Queen Liliuokalani's Protest to the Annexation of Hawaii." June 17, 1897. National Archives, www.archives.gov/education/lessons/hawaii-pet. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/education/lessons/hawaii-petition>

Our Country. Josiah Strong, 1885. Strong, Josiah. "Our Country." 1885. Internet Archive, archive.org/details/ourcountryitsposs00stro.. Public domain. <https://archive.org/details/ourcountryitsposs00stro..>

US.20 — Interventionists vs Non-Interventionists

True Version of the Philippine Revolution. Emilio Aguinaldo, 1899. Aguinaldo, Emilio. "True Version of the Philippine Revolution." 1899. Library of Congress, www.loc.gov/item/08029953/. Public domain. <https://www.loc.gov/item/08029953/>

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Empire and War — Who Decided, and Who Paid?

This section complicates the imperialism-and-war narrative: who made the decisions, who benefited, and who bore the costs at home and abroad. It is History Hack-authored instructional synthesis grounded in this unit's sourced record — not a primary source.

Newly Colonized Peoples

The Spanish-American War made the U.S. an empire (US.21): Cubans, Puerto Ricans, Filipinos, and Pacific Islanders came under U.S. control — the Philippines only after a brutal war of resistance. Debates over intervention pitted expansionists against anti-imperialists (US.19–US.20).

Soldiers & Draftees

Once the U.S. entered the war (US.24), millions were drafted (US.25). Over 90,000 Tennesseans served; Sergeant Alvin C. York of Fentress County became one of the most decorated soldiers of the war.

The Home Front

Mobilization reshaped daily life (US.26): war industries, propaganda, and rationing — but also the Espionage and Sedition Acts, which curbed dissent, and new opportunities and tensions for women and Black Americans who moved for war work.

The Postwar World

Wilson's Fourteen Points promised a peace "without victory" and a League of Nations (US.27); the Senate's rejection of the League showed the limits of that vision. Cordell Hull of Tennessee would carry the idea forward decades later.

Residual note (known follow-up): sourced visuals and named Key-Figure entries for these histories remain pending.

Unit Reflection

Return to the unit's big question: as the United States became a world power and went to war, who made the decisions, who benefited, and who bore the costs — at home and abroad? Write a final claim with two pieces of evidence from different standards.

Part	Write here
My claim	
Evidence 1 (standard: ____)	
Evidence 2 (standard: ____)	
Why it matters today	